CYBER SAFETY GUY

LIVESTREAMING

(TikTok Live, Twitch, YouTube Live): A PARENT'S PLAIN-ENGLISH GUIDE

Livestreaming lets people broadcast video in real time to an audience. It can be fun, creative and social – but it also comes with risks. Here's what parents need to know.

70% of 13–17 year olds have watched a live stream — Ofcom (2023)

1 IN 3 teens have livestreamed or want to — Pew Research (2022)

45% of parents worry live streaming exposes kids to inappropriate content or contact — NCSA (2023)

LIVE Anything said or shown live can be seen, saved and shared instantly

1 WHAT IT IS

Live video broadcasts in real time to an audience.

2 HOW IT WORKS

Streamers go live from an app or device. Viewers watch and interact in the chat.

3 WHAT KIDS LIKE

Real-time connection, building communities, sharing talents, gaming, Q&A, "just chatting" and being creative.

4 KEY FEATURES

Live chat, likes, donations, follows, subscriptions, hosts/raids (Twitch), gifts and reactions.

5 THE RISKS

Strangers, harmful chat, oversharing, inappropriate content, pressure to keep streaming.

6 THE CONVERSATION

Talk early. Listen often. Agree boundaries together.

WHERE KIDS MIGHT GO LIVE

TikTok LIVE — Short-form video and live. Easy to go live from mobile.

Twitch — Popular for gaming, creative and "Just Chatting" streams.

YouTube Live — Livestream on your channel to subscribers and the public.

Other Apps — Instagram Live, Kick, Facebook Live and more. Check privacy settings.

WHAT PARENTS NEED TO UNDERSTAND

1. **Live is live.** There is no edit button.
2. **Anyone can watch, message or share.** Even if accounts are private.
3. **Your child's safety comes first.** Boundaries, settings and support make a big difference.

BY THE NUMBERS

56% of teens say they watch live streams weekly — Pew Research (2022)

1 IN 4 teens have chatted with someone they don't know during a live stream — NCSA (2023)

33% of teen streamers have received unwanted invites or messages — Internet Matters (2023)

2+ HOURS the average time tweens/teens spend watching streams daily — Common Sense Media (2023)

SAFETY FEATURES / SETTINGS

WHAT EXISTS

- **Privacy Settings** — Choose who can watch your live streams.
- **Chat Controls** — Slow mode, subscriber-only chat, blocked words.
- **Moderators** — Trusted people can help manage chat.
- **Block & Report** — Block users and report abuse or inappropriate behaviour.

WHAT TO CHANGE

- Go live to Friends or Subscribers only.
- Turn on chat filters and block keywords.
- Require approval for guests/hosts.
- Review who can send gifts or donations.

Find these in: Settings > Privacy & Safety (varies by platform).

STEP-BY-STEP: STREAM SAFELY

1. **Set your goals.** Why are you streaming? What are your boundaries?
2. **Check your privacy.** Choose who can watch and comment.
3. **Set up chat controls.** Use filters, slow mode or sub-only chat.
4. **Plan your space.** Keep personal info, location and screens private.
5. **Take breaks.** Schedule offline time and step away.
6. **Review and adjust.** Check settings and what's working. Get help if needed.

THE RISKS WORTH KNOWING

- **Inappropriate Comments** — Harmful, rude or sexual messages in chat.
- **Strangers & Predators** — Adults may target kids in live chats.
- **Oversharing** — Sharing too much can put safety at risk.
- **Pressure to Perform** — Feeling pressured to stream more or accept gifts.
- **Scams & Exploitation** — Fake giveaways, links and requests for money.
- **Content Going Viral** — Clips can be saved and shared without consent.

THE 10-MINUTE CONVERSATION

- What do you enjoy most about going live?
- Who usually joins your chat? Anyone you don't know?
- What boundaries do you want to set?
- What should you do if something makes you uncomfortable?

TRUST OVER SURVEILLANCE
Open talks build trust. Trust keeps kids safe.

IF THINGS GO WRONG

STAY CALM & GATHER EVIDENCE

- End the stream if it feels unsafe.
- Block the user.
- Save screenshots or recordings.
- Note the time, username and what happened.

REPORT & SEEK HELP

- Report the user on the platform.
- Use in-app report tools.
- Talk to a trusted adult.
- Contact Childline if you need support.
- Get help from school if needed.

★ You did the right thing. Help is available.

NEED TO TALK? CHILDLINE | **0800 1111** childline.org.uk | **YOU ARE NOT ALONE** We're here for you.